

King David: A Heart After God

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Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 10-17

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories - Book 42 of 60

Order: dannyshalom.etsy.com | Email: Dannyshalomnebiy@gmail.com | WhatsApp: +971525950021

Scene 2

[PICTURE: Samuel looking at Jesse's eldest son Eliab who is tall and handsome, but God's voice speaks to Samuel's heart. Samuel's expression shows he is listening to God internally while everyone watches expectantly. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Samuel looked at Eliab, Jesse's firstborn — tall, commanding, kingly in appearance. "Surely this is the Lord's anointed," Samuel thought. But God spoke clearly to Samuel's heart: "Do not consider his appearance or his height. I have rejected him. The Lord does not look at the things people look at. People look at the outward appearance, but the Lord looks at the heart."

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(Samuel ni'Eliyab bekhuri Isey re'ayo — newih, silitun, bimelki'u nigusawi. "Birigts izi nay Egzi'abher qibu'e'yu" Samuel hasebe. Gin Amlak nilbi Samuel binitsur tezarebo: "Ab melki'u wey qumetatu aytitumit. Netsigéyo alekhu. Egzi'abher sebat zitumitwo aytimit'n'yu. Sebat nab degawi melki'e yitimtu, gin Egzi'abher nab libi yitimit.")

Scene 3

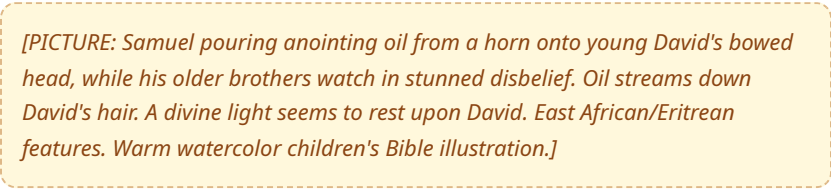
[PICTURE: Young David, the youngest son, being called from the sheep fields. He runs toward the house with his shepherd's staff, ruddy-faced and bright-eyed, while sheep graze behind him on green hills. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Seven sons passed before Samuel, and God rejected every one. "Are these all the sons you have?" Samuel asked Jesse. "There is still the youngest," Jesse replied almost dismissively, "but he is tending the sheep." No one had even considered David worthy of an invitation. Yet God had chosen the one everyone else had overlooked — the forgotten shepherd boy with a heart full of worship.

[illegible]

(*Shew'ate awedat qiami Samuel halefu, Amlak dima nikhulom netségom. "Izi'om diyom kulom awedatka?" Samuel ni'Isey hateto. "Gena iti zini'ase alo" Isey bizey gidi melese "gin abagi'e yigwasi alo." Hade'kwa niDawit nay idme biqu'e aygeberon. Amlak gin neti kulu seb ziresio meritsu nebere — neti ziteresie gwasa qol'a libu bimisigana zimel'a.*)

Scene 4



When David arrived, God said to Samuel, "Rise and anoint him; this is the one." In front of his astonished brothers, Samuel poured oil on the young shepherd's head. From that day forward, the Spirit of the Lord came powerfully upon David. He didn't look like a king, he didn't live in a palace, and no one expected greatness from him — but God saw what no one else could see.

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(Dawit mis metse Amlak niSamuel "Tenis'e qib'ayo; izi'yu iti zitemeretse" belo. Ab qidmi zitegeremu ahwatu Samuel ab ri'isi'ti ni'ishto gwas'a zeyti afisese. Kab'ta me'alti nidehar menfes Egzi'abher bihayili ab Dawit werede. Kem nigus aymesil'in nebere, ab bete mengisti ayneberan, hade'kwa ibet kab'u aytetsebéyen — gin Amlak kal'e seb kiri'yo zeykhil re'aye.)

Scene 5

[PICTURE: The giant Goliath in full armor standing in the valley between two armies, taunting the Israelite soldiers who cower in fear. Goliath towers over everyone, his spear like a weaver's beam. Dark storm clouds overhead. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Years passed. Israel faced the Philistine army, and a champion named Goliath — over nine feet tall, armored in bronze — challenged Israel daily for forty days. Every soldier, including David's brothers, trembled with fear. Goliath didn't just threaten Israel's army; he mocked the living God. No one dared to answer his challenge, revealing a crisis not of military strength but of faith.

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(Amettat halefu. Israel niserawit Filistiemawyan geTemet, Golyad zitebahle wana tewaga'i — li'ili tish'ate igri qumet, binhas zite'ateqe — ni'Israel arbi'a me'alti biyeme'altu yibdiha nebere. Nefsi wekef wetahader, ahwat Dawit hawisu, bifirihi yir'id nebere. Golyad niserawit Israel tiray ayeferarhen — nihiyaw Amlak alagétse. Hade'kwa nibidiho'u kiimlis aydeferen, nay wetahaderawi hayili zeyikone nay imnet qilwulaw mukhanu ar'aye.)

Scene 6

[PICTURE: Young David standing boldly before King Saul, refusing heavy armor that doesn't fit him. David holds his simple sling and picks smooth stones from a stream. His face shows calm determination while soldiers look on doubtfully. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

David, still just a teenager delivering food to his brothers, heard Goliath's mockery and was outraged — not for Israel's honor, but for God's. "Who is this uncircumcised Philistine that he should defy the armies of the living God?" David refused Saul's armor because his confidence wasn't in human weapons. He chose five smooth stones and his sling — tools he'd used as a shepherd. His faith wasn't reckless bravery; it was deep trust built through years of experiencing God's faithfulness.

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(Dawit gena men'isey ni'ahwatu megbi kibitsih kelo nay Golyad milgats semi'e'mo teqot'e — nikhbri Israel zeykone nikhbri Amlak. "Izi zeytegezre Filistiemawi niserawit hiyaw Amlak kibdih men'yu?" Dawit nay Sa'ol itqi abihu mikiñyatu ab seb'awi atsiwar ay'amin'n nebere. Hamushte limutsatat imin'n wenchifiti'n meretse — kem gwasas zitiqemelom nawti. Imnetu asha tib'at ayneberet'in; nay amettat nay Amlak te'amannet temekuro zitehantse amiq mi'iman nebere.)

Scene 7

[PICTURE: David releasing a stone from his sling with powerful motion toward the giant Goliath. The stone flies through the air in a dramatic arc. Both armies watch from hillsides. David's face shows fierce concentration and faith. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

David ran toward the giant — not away from him. "You come against me with sword and spear," David declared, "but I come against you in the name of the Lord Almighty!" One stone, slung with precision born of years of practice, struck Goliath's forehead. The giant fell face-down. The battle was won not by superior weaponry or physical strength, but by a young man who understood that God's power is made perfect in human weakness.

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(Dawit nab'ti gizuf goye — kab'u ayhademen. "Niskha bisefin bikuanatin timetseni"
Dawit aweje "ane gin bism Egzi'abher serawit yimetséka alekhu!" Hanti imni binay
amettat limimd zitefertre ki'ilet tewenchifa ginbar Golyad weqi'et. Iti gizuf bigetsu
wedeqe. Wig'e bizibeleitse atsiwar wey akalawi hayili zeykone hayili Amlak ab dikhiam
seb fitsuma kem zikhewn zitered'e men'isey'yu si'iru.)

Scene 9

[PICTURE: King Saul on his throne with a dark, jealous expression, gripping a spear tightly. In the background, crowds of women dance and sing praises for David. Saul's face is twisted with envy and suspicion. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

But jealousy is a poison that destroys from within. When the women sang, "Saul has slain his thousands, and David his tens of thousands," something broke inside the king. Saul began to view David not as a loyal servant but as a rival. Jealousy distorted his perception until he could see nothing but a threat in the young man who loved him most faithfully. This is what unchecked insecurity does — it turns friends into perceived enemies.

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(Gin qin'i kab wishti ziatfi'e harigits'yu. Anisti "Sa'ol ashihat qetilu, Dawit gin asertte ashihat" ilen mis zemera hade neger ab wishti'ti nigus tesebre. Sa'ol niDawit kem imun agelgali zeykone kem teqedadari kiri'iyō jemere. Qin'i ni'are'ayya'u azabe'o kisab neti bi'azyu bi'imnet zefqero men'isey sig'at tiray zeykone kal'e kiri'i zeykhil kone. Zeytequotsatserkayo nay wishti hitsret zigebro'yu — a'irukh nab tselai'ti yiqyir.)

Scene 15

[PICTURE: David being crowned king in Hebron, surrounded by elders and leaders of Israel who bow before him. David wears royal robes and a crown, his expression humble and grateful rather than proud. A long journey finally complete. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

After Saul's death in battle, David finally became king — first over Judah, then over all Israel. The shepherd boy who was overlooked by his own father now ruled the entire nation. But the path from anointing to throne had taken roughly fifteen years of suffering, running, and waiting. God's promises are certain, but His timeline often requires a patience that shapes us into the people worthy of carrying those promises. David's wilderness years weren't wasted — they were preparation.

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(Dihri mot Sa'ol ab wig'e Dawit ab mewed'a'eta nigus kone — qidim ab Yihuda dihri'u ab kula Israel. Iti bi'abu'u ba'ilu ziteresie gwas'a qol'a hiji nimilu'e hager yigiz'e nebere. Gin kab qib'at nab zifan ziwesede mengedi astat asertte hamush amet siqay, mihdam'n mitsibay'n nebere. Tesfatat Amlak rigitseña'yom gin gizi'u neti tesfa nimihza'e biqu'at nab mukhán ziqeritséna ti'igisti yihatit. Nay Dawit nay berekha amettat aytef'an — midilaw neberu.)

Scene 16

[PICTURE: King David dancing joyfully before the Ark of the Covenant as it enters Jerusalem. The city celebrates with music and singing. David dances with abandon, wearing simple linen rather than royal robes. People rejoice around him. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

David united all twelve tribes of Israel and made Jerusalem his capital. When he brought the Ark of the Covenant into the city, David danced before God with all his might — undignified in the eyes of some, but completely free in worship. He governed with justice, showed loyalty to old friends, and sought God's guidance in every decision. For years, David was the king God intended him to be: humble, worshipful, and dependent on God rather than his own wisdom.

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(Dawit nikhulen asertte kilte negedat Israel awehahade'mo niYerusalem ri'ise ketema'u gebera. Tabot kidan nab'ta ketema mis amts'e'a Dawit bikulu hayilu qidmi Amlak sa'isa'e — ab ayni hade hade zeykibur gin ab misigana fitsuma natsa. Bifitihi gez'a, ni'a'irukhu ta'amannet ar'aye, ab nefsi wekef wisane mimerah Amlak deleye. Ni'amettat Dawit Amlak kikhewn ziihasebo nigus nebere: tihut, amlakhi, ab Amlak zimirikhos kab nay ba'ilu tibeb zimirikhos zeykone.)

Scene 18

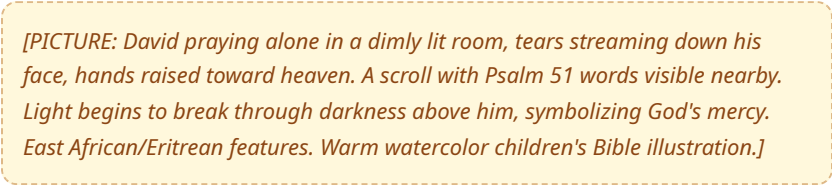
[PICTURE: The prophet Nathan standing boldly before King David on his throne, pointing his finger and declaring "You are the man!" David's face shows shock and the beginning of horrified realization. Courtiers look on in stunned silence. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

God sent the prophet Nathan to confront David — not with accusations but with a story about a rich man who stole a poor man's only lamb. David burned with anger at the injustice: "That man deserves to die!" Then Nathan spoke the words that shattered David's denial: "You are the man." In that moment, every wall David had built to hide his sin came crashing down. God's truth has a way of finding us no matter how deeply we try to bury our guilt.

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(Amlak nineb'iy Natan niDawit kigetimo sededdo — bikhisi zeykone bizanta habtam seb nay dikha hanti zineberetha begi'e zisereqe. Dawit bizeyfithawnet teqatsele: "Iti seb mot yigib'o!" Dihri'u Natan neti nay Dawit mikhihad zisebere qalat tezarebe: "Niskha ikha iti seb." Ab'ti himot nefsi wekef mendeq Dawit hati'atu kihabi'e zihanso ferefe. Haqi Amlak kindey tiliq ilna gunahna kinqebro'kwa nifetin kitrekhabena tikhil'ya.)

Scene 20



"Create in me a clean heart, O God, and renew a right spirit within me," David prayed in Psalm 51. "Do not cast me from your presence or take your Holy Spirit from me. Restore to me the joy of your salvation." David's repentance was not merely regret for getting caught — it was genuine grief over grieving God's heart. He understood that sin is ultimately an offense against the God who loved him, not merely a social mistake.

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(Tsiruy libi fitireley ata Amlak, qinu'e menfes dima ab wishtey hadsö) Dawit ab Mezmur 51 tseleye. "Kab qidmekha aytiderbeyeni qidus menfeskawun kabay aytiswedo. Hagos midihanká mileseley." Nisiha Dawit bimitihaz tiray ta'isa ayneberan — nilibi Amlak bimihzan haqeña hazen nebere. Hati'at ab mewedeta'eta neti zefqero Amlak ziqeni'e bedel mukhanu teredi'e, mahberawi gega tiray zeykone.)

Scene 25

[PICTURE: A teenager kneeling in prayer with a Bible open beside them, looking upward with hope. Behind them, faded images show key moments from David's life - the sling, the harp, the cave, the crown, the tears of repentance. A sunrise symbolizes new beginnings. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

David's story teaches us that God doesn't choose the perfect — He chooses the willing. He doesn't look at your appearance, your popularity, or your past failures. He looks at your heart. Will you, like David, be someone who runs TO God rather than FROM Him? Will you let your failures drive you to repentance rather than despair? The same God who restored David stands ready to restore you. Your story isn't over — and with God, the best chapters may still be ahead.

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(Zanta Dawit Amlak nifitsumat zeykone nifiqadeñatat kem zimirts yimihirena. Ab melki'ekha, tefetwunetkha, wey nay zihalefe widqetatkha aytimitin'yu. Nab libkha yitimit. Kem Dawit kab Amlak zihadim zeykone nab Amlak zigoy seb kitkhewn'do? Widqetatkha nab tesfa miqirats zeykone nab nisiha kimerihaakha kitfegid'do? Iti niDawit zihadese Amlak ni'akha'wun kihidseka dilu'e'yu. Zantakha aytewedi'an — mis Amlak dima zibeletsu mi'irafat gena qetsilom kikhonu yikhilu.)

God looks at the heart, not outward appearance. Even great people fail, but true repentance brings restoration.

Leadership requires humility — the willingness to serve before you reign, to wait for God's timing rather than seize what you want, and to own your failures honestly rather than hide behind excuses. Running from God never works; running TO God always does. Your worst failure does not have to be your final chapter.

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(Amlak nab libi yitimit'mber nab degawi melki'e ayikonen. Abeytii sebatwun yiwedqu'yom gin haqeenā nisiha mihidas yimits'e. Merihnet tihtina yihatit — qidni migza'e migilgal, zidelkayo michbat zeykone ningize Amlak mitsibay, bimikiniyat mihiba'e zeykone widqetatkhā biqini'ina miwnan mibqa'e. Kab Amlak mihdam keto ayserihin; nab Amlak migwaya kulu gize yiserih. Zikhefe'a widqetkha nay mewedā'eta mi'irafkha kikhewn ayedliyon.)

Bible Verse / ቅዱስ ስፍራ ቅዱስ

"The Lord does not look at the things people look at. People look at the outward appearance, but the Lord looks at the heart." — 1 Samuel 16:7

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*("Egzi'abher sebat zitimitwo aytimitin'yu. Sebat nab degawi melki'e yitimtu,
gin Egzi'abher nab libi yitimit." — 1 Samuel 16:7)*

Discussion Questions / 討論問題

1. Why do you think God chose David — the youngest, most overlooked son — instead of his impressive older brothers? What does this reveal about how God values people differently than the world does?

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2. David's faith against Goliath wasn't reckless — it was built on past experiences of God's faithfulness. How can your own small experiences of trusting God prepare you for bigger challenges ahead?

[illegible]

3. David refused to kill Saul twice, even though Saul was trying to murder him. When is it hardest for you to trust God's timing instead of taking matters into your own hands? What helps you wait?

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4. David's sin with Bathsheba came during a time of comfort and idleness, not during his years of struggle. Why do you think seasons of ease can sometimes be more spiritually dangerous than seasons of difficulty?

Prayer / ማጽናት

Lord God, thank You for the story of David — a reminder that You don't require perfection, but You do require honesty. Help me to be someone after Your own heart. Give me the faith to face my giants, the patience to wait for Your timing, the humility to serve before I lead, and the courage to repent quickly when I fall. Search my heart, God — show me what's hidden there. I don't want to run from You; I want to run toward You in every season of my life. Create in me a clean heart and renew a right spirit within me. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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(Goyta Amlak, bizanta Dawit nemesgineka — fitsimina zeykone qini'ina kem tihatit zizekir. Libkha zideli seb kikhewn hagizeni. Gizufatey kigetim imnet, ningizekha kititsbe ti'igisti, qidmi mimerah kigilgil tihtina, mis ziwediq qeltife kinisah tib'at habeni. Libey merimir Amlak — zitehab'a neger ari'yeni. Kabakha kihadem aydeelin; ab nefsi wekef weqti hiyiwetey nabakha kigwaye yideli. Tsiruy libi fitireley qinu'e menfes dima ab wishtey hadso. Bism Yesus Amen.)

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

Book 42 of 60

Thank you for reading! We pray this story encourages you to pursue God with your whole heart — knowing that He sees you, loves you, and is always ready to restore you when you turn back to Him.

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